

(a) *Canna* **(b)** Bamboo **(c)** *Borassus*

Figure 3.13: Types of Parallel venation

(a) Pinnately parallel venation **(b)** Palmately parallel(Convergent) **(c)** Palmately parallel (Divergent)

3.7.3 Phyllotaxy

The mode of arrangement of leaves on the stem is known as **phyllotaxy (Gk. Phyllon = leaf ; taxis = arrangement).** Phyllotaxy is to avoid over crowding of leaves and expose the leaves maximum to the sunlight for photosynthesis. The four main types of phyllotaxy are (1) Alternate (2) Opposite (3) Ternate (4) Whorled.

1. Alternate phyllotaxy

In this type there is only one leaf per node and the leaves on the successive nodes are arranged alternate to each other. Spiral arrangement of leaves show vertical rows are called **orthostichies**. They are of two types.

a) **Alternate spiral:** In which the leaves are arranged alternatively in a spiral manner. Example: *Hibiscus, Ficus*.

b) **Alternate distichous** or **Bifarious**: In which the leaves are organized alternatively in two rows on either side of the stem. Example: *Monoon longifolium* (=*Polyalthia longifolia*).

2. Opposite phyllotaxy

In this type each node possess two leaves opposite to each other. They are organized in two different types.

i. **Opposite superposed:** The pair of leaves arranged in succession are in the same direction, that is two opposite leaves at a node lie exactly above those at the lower node. Example: *Psidium*, *Quisqualis* (Rangoon creeper).

ii. **Opposite decussate:** In this type of phyllotaxy one pair of leaves is placed at right angles to the next upper or lower pair of leaves. Example: *Calotropis*, *Ocimum*

3. Ternate phyllotaxy

In this type there are three leaves attached at each node. Example: *Nerium*

4. Whorled (verticillate) type of phyllotaxy

In this type more than three leaves are present in a whorl at each node forming a circle or whorl. Example: *Allamanda*.

3.7.4 Leaf mosaic

In leaf mosaic leaves tend to fit in with one another and adjust themselves in such a way that they may secure the maximum amount of sunlight with minimum amount of overlapping. The lower leaves have longer petioles and successive upper leaves possess shorter petioles. Example: *Acalypha.*

3.7.5 Leaf type

The pattern of division of a leaf into discrete components or segments is termed leaf type.

Based on the number of segments

I. Simple leaf

A leaf is said to be simple when the petiole bears a single lamina; lamina may be entire



Alternate *Polyalthia* | Opposite Superposed *Psidium* | Opposite Decussate *Calotropis* | Ternate *Nerium* | Whorled *Allamanda*

Figure 3.14: Phyllotaxy

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